

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	APSS111/ APSS1A07														
Subject Title	Introduction to Psychology														
Credit Value	3														
Level	1														
GUR Requirements Intended to Fulfill	This subject intends to fulfill the following requirement(s) : ☐ Healthy Lifestyle ☐ AI and Data Analytics (AIDA) ☐ Innovation and Entrepreneurship (IE) ☐ Languages and Communication Requirement (LCR) ☐ Leadership Education and Development (LEAD) ☐ Service-Learning ☒ Cluster-Area Requirement (CAR) ☒ Human Nature, Relations and Development [CAR A] ☐ Science, Technology and Environment [CAR D] ☐ Chinese History and Culture [CAR M] ☐ Cultures, Organizations, Societies and Globalization [CAR N] ☒ China-Study Requirement ☐ Yes or ☒ No ☐ Writing and Reading Requirements ☐ English or ☐ Chinese														
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	<u>Exclusion:</u> For students taking <u>APSS111</u>, the exclusion subject is <u>APSS1A07</u>. For students taking <u>APSS1A07</u>, the exclusion subject is <u>APSS111</u>. For students taking <u>APSS298</u>, the exclusion subjects are <u>APSS111</u> & <u>APSS1A07</u>.														
Assessment Methods	<table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>100% Continuous Assessment</th><th>Individual Assessment</th><th>Group Assessment</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Practice Quizzes</td><td>10%</td><td>--</td></tr> <tr> <td>Written Assignments</td><td>50%</td><td>--</td></tr> <tr> <td>Class Participation</td><td>40%</td><td>--</td></tr> </tbody> </table> - The grade is calculated according to the percentage assigned; - The completion and submission of all component assignments are required for passing the subject; and - Student must pass all component(s) if he/she is to pass the subject.			100% Continuous Assessment	Individual Assessment	Group Assessment	Practice Quizzes	10%	--	Written Assignments	50%	--	Class Participation	40%	--
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Objectives	1. Harness systematic knowledge in the field of psychology with both historical and contemporary perspectives 2. Understand the research methods in psychology 3. Acquaint with contemporary trends and recent development in psychology 4. Develop critical thinking skills and use psychological method of enquiry to evaluate claims and ideas in popular media 5. Apply the acquired psychological concepts and theories in everyday life
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. Gain an understanding of the fundamentals of psychology b. Survey and appreciate research in psychology c. Develop their interest and critical thinking in human thought and behavior d. Relate psychology to applications in their everyday life e. Exercise skills on collaboration, communication, research, writing, & leveraging emerging technology towards learning
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. The Dimensions of Psychology - Aspects of Psychology - A Brief History of Psychology - Value and Contributions of Psychology to Human Life 2. The Neuro-biological Foundations of Psychology - Central Nervous System (CNS) / Limbic System / Endocrine System - Genetic Influence on Behavior / Major functions of CNS / Neuro-imaging 3. Sensation and Perception - Sensory Processes - Principles of Perceptual Organization - Perceptual Constancy and Development 4. Learning - Classical Conditioning - Operant Conditioning - Social and Cognitive Approaches to Learning 5. Memory - Memory Processes from Sensory Input to Long-term Memory - Improving Memory - Constructive Memory 6. Intelligence, Cognition and Language - Intelligence: Classical and Contemporary theories - Forming Concepts and Solving Problems - Development of Language, Reason and Thought 7. Perspectives of Human Development - Cognitive Development - Social and Personality Development

	- Emotional Development / Moral Development 8. Social Influence and Human Behaviors - Perceiving Others and Attribution - Attitudes and Behavior - Interpersonal Attraction - Social and Group Influences 9. Personality Theories, Research and Assessment - Personality Development - Personality Assessment 10. Psychological Disorders – Diagnosis & Treatment - Brief Overview of Abnormal Behavior: Myths, Realities and Controversies - Culture and Psychopathology - Elements of the Treatment Processes / Current Trends and Issues in Treatment
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	Both face-to-face lectures and online lecture materials are directly delivered and prepared by the subject teaching team. Blended learning activities are designed to encourage students' self-study beyond lecture contact hours. The subject teaching team strive to reach a flexible balance of interactive activities through direct student-teacher contact, online self-assessment, in-class exercises, small group discussions, role-play, and case illustration where applicable. Multi-media materials and immersive learning environment would be introduced to facilitate learning where applicable. Web-assisted quizzes are arranged to enhance students' understanding of the psychological concepts acquired from the lectures, web-assisted deliverables and assigned readings. These methods are considered as both a supplement to 13 lectures and a self-learning tool for reinforcing students' integration and internalization. Prompt feedback can be provided for each student after taking the web-based assessment and practice quizzes. The on-line forum may also provide a platform for interactive discussions among students, and for exchanging views with the subject lecturer. Flipped Classroom sessions are incorporated to promote constructivist and collaborative learning in this subject. Students will engage in 2-3 sessions on the learning units through the flipped classroom approach, in which they will view learning materials before classes and engage in problem solving and experiential learning activities in physical class sessions. Students are also required to take part in up-to-3 hours of psychological experiments, so that they learn how empirical studies are conducted in real contexts.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes

(Note 4)

Specific assessment methods/tasks	% Weighting (Individual %/ Group %)	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				
		a	b	c	d	e
1. Practice Quizzes	10% (10% /0%)	✓	✓	✓		✓
2. Written Assignments	50% (50% /0%)	✓	✓	✓		✓
3. Class Participation	40% (40% /0%)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Total	100 %					

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

Practice Quizzes

Practice quizzes (10%) assigned through the Learn@PolyU learning management system cover the subject syllabus and essential reading requirements. They may be designed in the form of multiple-choice and/or short-question formats. These practice quizzes are designed to assess students' learning at the recall, comprehension, analysis and application levels, that are adaptable for a wide range of course contents and learning outcomes.

Written Assignments

Students will be able to reflect on application of psychology concepts and theories by selecting one thematic lecture topic for writing a reflective journal (50%: 20% Draft & 30% Revision) and reflect on how psychology helps the study of their disciplinary domain and professional practice.

Class Participation

Learning artefact engagement via Learn@PolyU learning management system and in-class lecture participation (20%): Participation in learning activities including preparation by reading class materials online via collaborative annotations tool, and in-class engagement through responses via Students' Response System (SRS), will reflect students ongoing progress and engagement in class learning activities.

Engagement in Flipped Classroom Sessions (15%): To evaluate the effort in flipped classroom sessions, students' preparation on learning materials before class via Learn@PolyU and their subsequent engagement in problem solving and experiential learning activities in physical class sessions will be assessed towards flipped classroom sessions participation.

Research participation (5%): Research-integrated learning allows students to learn how psychological research is designed and implemented from an experiential approach. Through research participation, students will be provided with hands-on opportunities in participating in psychological research studies. Participating in psychological research enable students to apply and integrate psychological theories into the real-life practice. Students earn the participation marks by completing an experiment or surveys and consolidating their participation with a brief review on the research project participated. All these experiential learning and evidence-based research

	experience would enhance students' understanding of the essential theoretical and empirical knowledge of the psychological theories acquired in lectures as well as their indigenous and global trends. Coursework is based on continuous assessment. Quizzes, written assignments, and class participation activities are set for all students who are required to demonstrate their level of psychological knowledge learned from this introductory subject. Assessment is also moderated through various means: (1) setting clear and specific assessment guidelines; (2) regular discussions among the subject lecturer and all supportive staff concerned; and (3) moderation by an internal moderator for this subject. Academic Integrity https://www.polyu.edu.hk/ar/academic-integrity/introduction/ We expect students to honor and practice academic integrity on their academic work in an honest and ethical manner, following the conventions and code of practice of their chosen discipline or profession. Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) in learning and assessments https://www.polyu.edu.hk/edc/explore-a-topic/generative-ai/ PolyU takes an open and forward-looking stance on the use of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools as a positive and creative force in education, and the incorporation of such use in innovative learning, teaching, and assessment practices. While embracing the use of new technology in education, PolyU upholds the principle that students must adhere to high standards of academic integrity in all forms of assessments. The Student Code of Conduct and the policy on academic integrity apply to the use of GenAI in student work.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lecture	39 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Web-based quizzes	3 Hrs.
	▪ Self-reading	28 Hrs.
	▪ Preparation for written assignments and web-based quizzes	47 Hrs.
	▪ Psychological experiments	3 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	120 Hrs.
Reading List and References	<u>Textbook</u> <i>Psychology 2/E</i>. Open source textbook provided by OpenStax. Available under a Creative Commons Attribution License v4.0. © 2022. Available at https://openstax.org/details/books/psychology-2e <u>References</u> Sun, C. T.-L. (2015). <i>Psychology in Asia: An Introduction</i> (1st ed.): Cengage.	

	(ISBN: 9789814441384) Bond, M. H. (Ed.). (2010). <i>The Oxford handbook of Chinese psychology</i> . New York: Oxford University Press. (ISBN: 9780198738572).
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon completion of the subject. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time over-crowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method purports to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.